

Absolutely — **unwind** is a very good target because your passage uses it figuratively:

> “First of all, it helps her **unwind**.”

Here **unwind** means **relax after stress or work**. But the literal core is **to undo something that has been wound/coiled**, and from there we get figurative uses involving relaxation, reversing a process, closing positions, and gradually undoing arrangements.

Word family: **unwind / unwound / unwinding**

Base word: unwind

Past tense: unwound

Past participle: unwound

-ing form: unwinding

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “First of all, it helps her **unwind**.”

Meaning in your passage: **unwind = relax after stress — 放鬆；鬆弛身心**

Here **unwind** means:

> **to relax mentally and physically after being busy, tense, or stressed.**

繁體中文：

在忙碌、緊張或有壓力之後，讓自己放鬆下來、舒緩身心

Natural translation:

> “It helps her unwind.”

「這能幫助她**放鬆身心 / 舒緩壓力**。」

So here:

> **unwind = 放鬆、減壓**

1. **unwind = relax after stress (身心) — 放鬆；舒緩壓力**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Gardening helps her **unwind**.”

「園藝能幫助她**放鬆身心**。」

Practice 2

> “I like to listen to music after work to **unwind**.”

「我喜歡下班後聽音樂來**放鬆一下**。」

Practice 3

> “A short walk helps me unwind before bed.”

「睡前散步一會兒能幫助我**放鬆下來**。」

****unwind — figurative = 在緊張、忙碌或壓力之後逐漸恢復放鬆狀態****

2. ****unwind = uncoil / untwist something (物理) — 解開；放開；把纏繞物攤開****

The literal core meaning.

Practice 4

> “She **unwound** the string from the box.”

「她把纏在盒子上的繩子**解開**。」

Practice 5

> “He slowly unwound the cable.”

「他慢慢把電線**解開 / 放開**。」

****unwind = 把原本捲起、纏繞或扭在一起的東西逐步解開****

3. ****unwind = become uncoiled / come loose (自身解開) — 鬆開；散開****

The intransitive version.

Practice 6

> “The rope began to **unwind**.”

「繩子開始**鬆開 / 散開**。」

Practice 7

> “The thread unwound from the reel.”

「線從線軸上**鬆開了**。」

unwind — intransitive = 原本捲起或纏繞的東西自行逐步鬆開

4. **unwind** + wrapped/bandaged item (拆開) — 解開纏繞物；拆去纏帶

A common contextual extension of the literal sense.

Practice 8

> “The nurse **unwound** the bandage.”

「護士把繃帶**解開 / 拆下**。」

Practice 9

> “She unwound the scarf from her neck.”

「她把圍巾從脖子上**解下來**。」

unwind = 把纏繞在某物 / 某人身上的帶狀物逐步解開

5. **unwind** = reverse / undo a process or arrangement (比喻) — 逐步撤銷；逆轉；解除

A major figurative extension.

Practice 10

> “The company is trying to **unwind** the arrangement.”

「公司正嘗試**逐步解除 / 撤銷**這項安排。」

Practice 11

> “The policy cannot be unwound overnight.”

「這項政策不可能在一夜之間**完全撤回 / 逆轉**。」

unwind — figurative = 把已建立的安排、制度、交易或過程逐步拆解、撤銷或逆轉

This is common in:

- * business
- * finance
- * law
- * policy
- * contracts

6. **unwind a position/trade (金融) — 平倉 ; 解除持倉**

A technical financial use.

Practice 12

> “The fund began to **unwind its position**.”

「該基金開始**平倉 / 減持並退出原有持倉**。」

Practice 13

> “Investors rushed to unwind risky trades.”

「投資者急於**解除高風險交易部位 / 平倉**。」

unwind a position = 逐步取消、出售或反向操作原有投資持倉，使交易回到較少或沒有曝險的狀態

This is a genuine domain-specific sense, but secondary for general learners.

7. **unwind leverage/debt/complex structure (金融 / 商業) — 去槓桿 ; 解除複雜安排**

A broader business branch of #5/#6.

Practice 14

> “The bank spent months ****unwinding**** risky investments.”

「銀行花了數月****逐步退出 / 解除****高風險投資。」

Practice 15

> “The company is unwinding parts of the old structure.”

「公司正在****逐步拆解****舊有架構的部分安排。」

****unwind = 對已經建立、彼此相連的金融或商業安排作逐步解除****

I would treat this as a domain extension of the “reverse/undo” sense rather than a separate lexical meaning.

8. ****unwind a story / plot (較少見 , 比喻) — 展開 ; 逐步揭示****

This use exists, though it is less central than the meanings above.

Practice 16

> “The mystery slowly ****unwinds**** over several chapters.”

「謎團在幾個章節中慢慢****展開 / 揭示****。」

Practice 17

> “As the story unwinds, the characters’ motives become clearer.”

「隨著故事****逐步展開****，角色的動機變得更清楚。」

****unwind — narrative = 故事、情節或事件逐步展開、顯露其細節****

This is somewhat literary and much less common than ****unfold****.

Important distinction: ****unwind vs relax****

****relax****

broad, neutral:

= 放鬆

unwind

often specifically:

= after stress, work, pressure, or a busy day, gradually relax

> “I need to relax.”

general.

> “I need to unwind after work.”

= 我下班後需要**放鬆一下、舒緩壓力**。

So **unwind** carries a stronger idea of **coming down from tension**.

Important distinction: **unwind vs slow down**

You just curated **slow**.

slow down

= reduce pace.

unwind

= become mentally/physically more relaxed.

Someone can:

> slow down without unwinding

For example, they may stop working but still feel stressed.

And someone can unwind through an activity that is not especially slow, such as exercise.

Important distinction: **unwind vs rest**

rest

= stop activity / allow body or mind to recover.

unwind

= reduce tension and stress.

> “I rested for an hour.”

「我休息了一小時。」

> “I listened to music to unwind.”

「我聽音樂來放鬆心情。」

They overlap, but **unwind** focuses more on tension release.

Important distinction: **unwind vs decompress**

decompress

informal/figurative:

= mentally come down from stress, especially after intense work.

unwind

more common everyday word.

> “I need time to decompress.”

and

> “I need time to unwind.”

are close, but **unwind** is more universal.

Important distinction: **unwind vs untangle**

unwind

= undo something coiled/wrapped around itself or something else.

untangle

= separate knots/confused strands.

> unwind a cable

> = 把捲起的電線放開

> untangle a cable

> = 把打結纏亂的電線解開

Different physical structure.

Important distinction: **unwind** vs **unwrap**

unwind

= undo something wound around.

unwrap

= remove wrapping around an object.

> unwind a bandage

> = 解開繃帶

> unwrap a present

> = 拆禮物包裝

Not interchangeable in many contexts.

Important distinction: **unwind** vs **undo**

undo

very broad:

= reverse, unfasten, cancel, remove effect.

unwind

more specific:

= gradually reverse a previously built-up, wound, or complex arrangement.

So:

> unwind a financial position

is more natural than:

> undo a financial position

Important distinction: **unwind** vs **unfold**

unwind

literal:

= uncoil

figurative:

= relax / reverse arrangements

unfold

literal:

= open something folded

figurative:

= events/story gradually develop

For narratives:

> “The story unfolds”

is much more common than:

> “The story unwinds.”

Important grammar note: irregular forms

> **unwind** → **unwound** → **unwound**

Not:

> ***unwinded*** ❌

Examples:

> “She unwound the cable.”

> “The cable has been unwound.”

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **unwind — relax** = 放鬆；舒緩壓力
- * **unwind — uncoil** = 解開；把捲起物放開
- * **unwind — become uncoiled** = 鬆開；散開
- * **unwind — bandage/scarf** = 解下 / 拆開纏繞物
- * **unwind — arrangement/process** = 逐步撤銷 / 逆轉 / 解除
- * **unwind — finance** = 平倉 / 解除持倉
- * **unwind — business structure** = 逐步拆解複雜安排
- * **unwind — narrative** = 逐步展開 / 揭示，較少見
- * **unwound** = unwind 的過去式 / 過去分詞

This is a good example of a word with a **very clear literal core**:

> wound/coiled → unwind

and then a strong metaphorical extension:

> tension/complex arrangement wound up → gradually release or undo it.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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unwind — relax	在忙碌、緊張或受壓之後逐漸放鬆身心
unwind — uncoil	把原本捲起、纏繞或扭在一起的東西逐步解開
unwind — intransitive	原本捲起 / 纏繞的東西自行鬆開、散開
unwind — bandage/scarf	把纏在某人 / 某物上的帶狀物逐步解開或取下
unwind — arrangement/process	把已建立的制度、安排、交易或過程逐步撤銷 / 逆轉
unwind — finance	透過出售、反向交易等方式逐步平掉原有持倉
unwind — business structure	逐步拆解已建立而彼此相連的商業 / 金融安排
unwind — narrative	故事或事件逐步展開並揭示細節；較少見

For your original sentence

> “First of all, it helps her ****unwind****.”

The exact meaning is:

****unwind = 在忙碌工作和壓力之後，讓身心逐漸放鬆下來****

So naturally:

> ****「首先，做園藝能幫助她放鬆身心。」****

or more conversationally:

> ****「首先，園藝可以讓牠放鬆一下、舒緩壓力。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

> ****unwind**** → 放鬆減壓

> ****unwind a cable**** → 把捲起的電線解開

> ****unwind an arrangement**** → 逐步撤銷安排

> ****unwind a position**** → 平倉 / 解除持倉

> ****unwind vs slow down**** → 放鬆身心 vs 放慢節奏